

MUSIC

GETTING BETTER

Out with their third album, dream-pop duo **Parekh & Singh** are after improvement, not adulation

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Partners in High Places

Jaimin Rajani's talent lifts his debut album, but so do his collaborators

In 2020, after several years of writing songs, Jaimin Rajani finally felt ready to put something out. The Kolkata-based singer-songwriter began putting together tracks and working with co-producer Subharaj Ghosh to transform the scratch demos, recorded on his phone with just a voice and acoustic guitar, into full-band arrangements, honing those stripped-down songs into something grander. Thus, his 14-song album, *Cutting Loose*, was born—a thoughtful and emotive release that stands out as a mature debut. It's also an album that boasts a series of Indian indie music heavyweights popping up as unexpected collaborators, including, among others, the powerhouse frontman of Indian Ocean, Rahul Ram. "I didn't want to put out a half-baked attempt." Each element of the record—which rests in a reflective, intimate space, driven by his voice and the guitar—was painstakingly worked on by Rajani, everything from the sonic approach to the selection of the songs.

It's an intricately crafted record, with hopeful refrains and a

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